

# WEB Usability and Accessibility— It's Time to Act Fast

In an imperfect world that includes a significant number of variously challenged people, standards of usability and accessibility are required so that those with different abilities have full access to the World Wide Web. The author presents a primer on usability and accessibility standards.



**A**ccording to United Nations' statistics, around 15 per cent of the world's total population, which amounts to one billion people, live with a disability. There are various categories of disability such as attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorders, visual impairments, brain injuries, hearing impairment, learning disabilities, medical disabilities, physical disabilities, psychiatric disabilities and speech and language disabilities. Persons with disabilities form one of the world's largest minority communities. For a section of these people who are only partially disabled, the World Wide Web opens up new horizons.

As Tim Berners-Lee, the inventor of the World Wide Web, said, "The power of the Web is in its universality.

Access by everyone, regardless of disability, is an essential aspect." The Internet has opened up new opportunities for people irrespective of their location and status. It can benefit the disabled and able, alike. In many ways, it is extremely useful for the disabled as it empowers them to get equal rights to information and other essential services. And with the evolution of the IoT, wearable technologies and smart devices offer ample opportunities for all of us to get connected, removing the barrier between able and disabled persons.

The people with visual impairments, motor and mobility issues, auditory impairments, cognitive/intellectual impairments can benefit tremendously from